

The Time That Beats: Redefining the Pulse of the Real

Benjamin Brécheteau
BRÈCHETEAU RESEARCH INSTITUTE

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brecheteaub@gmail.com

Abstract

This article reformulates the concept of time from the Chronon Field $\Phi(x)$ introduced in the treatise *Time May Not Exist!*. It explores the hypothesis of a rhythmic physics in which reality is structured by beats rather than continuous flow. By crossing modern physics, biology, and philosophy, it redefines temporal coherence as a phenomenon of local synchronization, opening the way to an ethics of rhythm.

Keywords — *Chronon Field, public time, synchronization, rhythm, quantum gravity, philosophy of time*

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I — The Illusion of Flow

You were taught that time flows, that it slips away like water from an overturned hourglass—a ribbon that races on and carries you off. You watch it go by, powerless. You measure, you count, you classify.

But listen closer: nothing “flows.” Atoms vibrate, neurons oscillate, galaxies breathe slowly. Everywhere, the world beats.

Modern physics broke the old clock: there is no “universal present,” no homogeneous river where instants line up obediently. What we call time is a convenient façade—a coordination regime, an operational convention that relativity made local. Behind it, the real texture—of the living as of the equations—pulses.

A beat is not a metaphor: it is a structure, a framework of the real, an alternation of tension and release. The real does not flow, it alternates: action / rest, emission / reception, excitation / relaxation. At the quantum level, each energy transition $E = h\nu$ can be heard as an elemental beat—a quantum of rhythm. The present is not a slice; it is a rhythmic opening, an interval of *tenue*. Every system has its signature, a frequency fingerprint.

This manifesto will propose the following *operational* reading: a scalar field $\Phi(x)$ describes the *local frequency of coherence* (dimension $[\Phi] = \text{s}^{-1}$). Durations are no longer uniform lengths but *rhythms of coherence*; “to endure” means to *maintain oneself* in a cadence compatible with one’s environment. When this cadence goes awry—in a brain, a star, a society—local continuity unthreads: aging, decay, dying become tempo detunings, losses of phase with the environment.

We do not interpret $\Phi(x)$ as (i) a rebranding of proper time, nor (ii) a generic decoherence rate: Φ is operationally defined only through GR-subtracted, gauge-safe relational residuals and closure tests.

II — The Physics of the Beat

Look at a quartz oscillator: it beats at 32 768 Hz ($= 2^{15}$), not to “imitate” the real but to stabilize an exploitable cadence. Look at an electron: its spin does not “flow,” it precesses around an axis with a Larmor frequency typically in the *gigahertz* depending on the applied field. Look at your heart: it does not advance, it restarts, ~ 70 bpm ($\simeq 1$ Hz). At every scale, the universe replays its existence in the form of a *rhythm*.

We call the *Chronon Field* $\Phi(x)$ the **local frequency of coherence** (dimension $[\Phi] = \text{s}^{-1}$). Φ is neither a new metric nor an energy: it *reparametrizes* the effective cadences of processes without altering the light cones or adding any $T_{\mu\nu}$. Each point of spacetime thus carries a *proper cadence of the real’s holding*.

Relativity showed that divergent clocks detune according to their velocity and potential; the Chronon Field *operationalizes* this intuition: every configuration of the world has its local tempo, practically readable by frequency comparisons.

Operational distinction (anti-misreading). Proper time parameterizes individual worldlines and remains silent about cross-system phase compatibility. Standard decoherence rates describe environment-induced loss of coherence within a system, but do not define a shared cadence across distinct systems once GR and known couplings are modeled. $\Phi(x)$ is neither of these. Operationally, it is a *relational coherence-rate*: a local parameter accessible only through comparative synchronization failures between otherwise well-modeled clocks or coherent systems, after subtracting GR-predicted effects and known environmental decoherence. Its signature is therefore not an absolute rate, but a persistent, gauge-safe residual in relative phase or frequency alignment across systems, where relational closure is expected to hold.

Frequency landmarks. Watch quartz: 32 768 Hz; resting heart: ~ 1 Hz; circadian rhythm: $1/86\,400\text{ s}^{-1}$; cortical oscillations: 0.1–100 Hz; millisecond pulsars: up to ~ 700 Hz.

This shift of viewpoint changes the very object of durations. Durations cease to be homogeneous lengths; they become *rhythms of coherence*. A system does not “last” so many seconds: it *maintains itself* within a band of compatibility ($\Delta\Phi$) with its environment. When the cadence derails—brain, star, organization—local continuity breaks: phase losses, desynchronizations, weakening of *tenue*.

The formal relations that follow (reparametrization $d\tau = \Phi^{-1}dt$, current $J^\mu = \Phi u^\mu$, continuity law $\partial_\mu J^\mu = \Gamma$) will be stated in §V (*Conventions & master laws*) and justified in the *Formal Appendices of Article 2* (*Chronon Field and the End of Timeless Physics*).

III — Listening to the World Beat

Place your hand on the table: beneath the skin, billions of cells oscillate. Their concert is your present. The seconds on the wall say nothing about it; they *coordinate* clocks, not consciousness. The real present is not *countable*, it is *tenable*: a beat regular enough for a gesture to hold, for a thought to unfold.

In matter, it is the same. A “stable” particle is one whose internal rhythm stays in phase with its environment. A coherent system is a choir of compatible beats: atoms in phase in a Bose–Einstein condensate, aligned spins in a crystal, locked oscillators in a laser. At the global scale, entropy increases; locally, the world *recomposes* itself incessantly by resonance, with amplitudes that dissipate, regenerate, or couple depending on the interactions.

Astrophysicists track the pulsation of neutron stars (up to ~ 700 Hz); at the other extreme, atomic clocks compare relative frequencies at 10^{-18} and read a gravitational shift **given by** Eq. (3)—an operational sign that the *rhythm* of the real varies with gravity (see §V, *Weak-field dictionary*). The reading posits no new metric: it observes that *cadences* modulate and that a phenomenon’s *tenue* is measured as *tempo compatibility* with its environment.

Thus, “listening” to the world means measuring *phase offsets* and *capture bands*. When alignment is lost, the coherence window closes: interference contrasts fade, memories blur, organizations *shift*. When alignment returns, the present reopens. In this manifesto, we take this dynamics seriously and *formalize* it by a field $\Phi(x)$ that makes these openings and closings calculable.

Box 1 — Dimensionless residual ε_Φ & anti-gauge loops

Definition (operational reading). We read the local cadence via a *dimensionless residual* on the clock comparison after subtracting the general-relativistic model (gravitational + kinematic):

$$\left(\frac{\Delta\nu}{\nu}\right)_{\text{res}} \equiv \left(\frac{\Delta\nu}{\nu}\right)_{\text{obs}} - \left(\frac{\Delta\nu}{\nu}\right)_{\text{GR}} = \varepsilon_\Phi. \quad (1)$$

Here ε_Φ is dimensionless and represents the *non-metric signature* attributed to the Chronon Field $\Phi(x)$ (reparametrization of duration, light cones unchanged, no added $T_{\mu\nu}$). **Operational distinction (anti-misreading).** Proper time parameterizes a single worldline and is silent about *cross-system* phase compatibility. Standard decoherence rates quantify primarily *intra-system* coherence loss given an environment model; they do not, by themselves, define a shared cadence across distinct systems once GR and known couplings are subtracted. In this box, ε_Φ targets a third layer: *inter-system synchronizability* operationally accessed through gauge-safe closure failures (loops/permutations/triangles) and GR-subtracted relational residuals.

Intuition. If Φ is strictly constant, any common time re-labeling is absorbed and $\varepsilon_\Phi = 0$. *Variations* (spatial/temporal) of Φ induce residuals correlated *between sites* after GR subtraction. Detection thus targets a *common term* robust to instrumentation.

Anti-gauge loops (null tests & system vetoes). Build *closed cycles* canceling timestamp gauges and link errors:

- *Co-located toggle* $A \leftrightarrow B$ (same sensors, $\Delta h = 0$): requires $(\Delta\nu/\nu)_{\text{res}} \approx 0$ (dimensionless neutral witnesses).
- *Link permutation* (fiber/GNSS/free-space) between A–B: the estimate ε_Φ must be *independent* of the medium.
- *Triangular loop* $A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow A$: the oriented sum of *link* residuals cancels; a common remainder flags ε_Φ .
- *Time forward/backward* (synchronous Ramsey sequences): symmetrize before/after to cancel slow instrumental drifts.

Acceptance/failure criteria. (i) Co-local null tests vanish to $<$ statistical noise; (ii) stability of ε_Φ under link permutations; (iii) signal persistence on closed loops; (iv) negative regression on controls (temperature/optical load/vibrations).

Pipeline P1–P4 (summary, thresholds, null tests).

- **P1 — Clocks (vertical):** ε_Φ via Δh ; *null* co-local, link permutations; target: sub- 10^{-18} stability, Δh cm–m.
- **P2 — Qubits (cQED/ions):** Ramsey/echo contrasts $\Rightarrow \Delta\Gamma$ vs $g\Delta h/c^2$ (towers/parabolic flights); controls T_1/T_φ ; includes *entangled pairs* (visibility vs gradient, same parameters ξ, b).
- **P3 — Long baselines** (10^2 – 10^4 km): multi-site correlated drifts $S_y(f)$; veto via independent links (fiber/GNSS/free-space).
- **P4 — Cognition (exploratory):** minimal detectable effect $\Delta\text{PLV} \sim 0.03$ – 0.05 under controlled reference jitter (< 1 ms) and pre-registration.

Formal pointer (proofs). Mathematical development, weak-field linearization and conservation properties: see *Formal Appendices* of **Article 2 Chronon Field and the End of Timeless Physics** (A–C).

$$\left(\frac{\Delta\nu}{\nu}\right)_{\text{GR}} = \frac{\Delta U}{c^2} \simeq \frac{g\Delta h}{c^2} \quad (2)$$

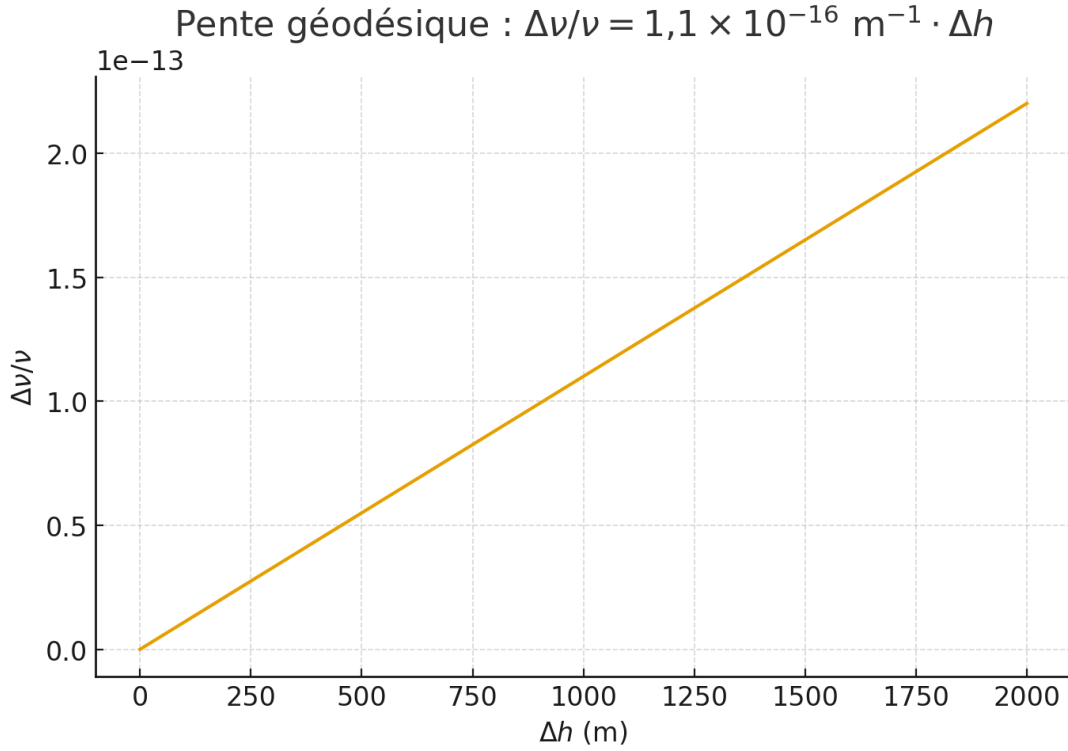


Figure 1 Geodesic slope — GR calibration of the fractional frequency. Reference relation: $\Delta\nu/\nu = \Delta U/c^2 \simeq g \Delta h/c^2$ (Eq. (2)); numerical slope: $1,1 \times 10^{-16}$ per meter (Eq. (3)).

With $g = 9,806\,65 \text{ m s}^{-2}$ and $c = 299\,792\,458 \text{ m s}^{-1}$, we obtain the numerical slope:

$$\left(\frac{\Delta\nu}{\nu} \right)_{\text{GR}} \simeq 1,1 \times 10^{-16} \text{ per meter} \times \Delta h \text{ [m]} \quad (3)$$

[Benchmarks (GR model)]

$$\left(\frac{\Delta\nu}{\nu} \right)_{\text{GR}} \simeq 1,1 \times 10^{-16} \times \Delta h \text{ (per m)}$$

Δh	$\Delta\nu/\nu$ (GR)
1 m	$1,1 \times 10^{-16}$
10 m	$1,1 \times 10^{-15}$
100 m	$1,1 \times 10^{-14}$
1 km	$1,1 \times 10^{-13}$

Pipeline: subtract (2) from the measured value to define the residual $\varepsilon_\Phi \equiv (\Delta\nu/\nu)_{\text{obs}} - (\Delta\nu/\nu)_{\text{GR}}$ (see Eq. (1)).

IV — The Return of the Living

The living does not escape the Chronon Field: it inhabits it. Its rhythms—cardiac, neuronal, circadian—are not biological accidents, but *tunings* to the world’s pulsation. The circadian rhythm (24 h) expresses adjustment to planetary rotation; perceptual windows $\sim 30\text{--}300$ ms organize experience into *grains of coherence*; cortical oscillations 0.1–100 Hz modulate access and memory. To “feel” time is to *synchronize* with it.

Rhythmic reading. Define the *local beat* $T(x) = \Phi(x)^{-1}$. A lived episode corresponds to a *locking window* where the dephasing tied to conductive delays ($v \in [1, 100] \text{ m s}^{-1}$) remains under a threshold ε :

$$\Delta\varphi \simeq 2\pi f \frac{d}{v}, \quad |\Delta\varphi| < \varepsilon \text{ during } T \approx \tau_c \in [30, 300] \text{ ms.}$$

When alignment unravels, the window closes (loss of contrast, forgetting, disorganization); when it returns, the present reopens.

P4 — Cognition (exploratory, downstream). We include **neurochronometry** as an *auxiliary downstream layer*, conditional on the operational core (P1–P3) being constrained and passing null tests. (Consolidated nomenclature: P1 *clocks*, P2 *qubits*, P3 *long baselines*, P4 *cognition*.)

- *Pre-registered tasks* (TOJ, 2–8 Hz envelope tracking, theta–gamma working memory). Main measures: PLV/wPLI, ITPC, circular phase variance.
- *Controlled manipulations*: sensory load ($\pm$), EM shielding ($\pm$), circadian alignment (morning/evening), controlled reference jitter (PTP/NTP). Hypotheses: **H1**— $\text{PLV}(f) \uparrow$ if the phase variability of Φ (instrumental window) $\downarrow$; **H2**—a jitter Δt such that $2\pi f \Delta t > \varepsilon$ degrades ITPC and performance.
- *Null tests*: wiring/source permutations, “eyes closed”/white-noise controls, block counterbalancing, independence from timestamp media (PTP vs NTP).
- *Indicative thresholds*: minimal detectable effect $\Delta\text{PLV} \sim 0.03\text{--}0.05$ (power > 0.8), reference stability < 1 ms; robust correlation between rhythmic metrics (PLV/wPLI) and temporal JNDs.

Anchoring to public time. UTC/GNSS networks and PTP/NTP provide the alignment framework: they do not *state* the lived present, they *condition* it. In this paper, cognition is treated only as a *downstream sensor candidate*: controlled variations of the alignment regime may be reflected jointly in phase metrics and performance, but **no** inference about Φ is accepted from P4 unless P1–P3 constraints and controls pass.

Formal pointer. Justifications (linearization, weak-field links, phase continuities) are detailed in the *Formal Appendices* of **Article 2 Chronon Field and the End of Timeless Physics**.

V — Toward a Rhythmic Physics (conventions & master laws)

Conventions (operational). We adopt $[\Phi] = \text{s}^{-1}$ (local frequency of coherence) and separate the rhythmic loss Γ from environmental losses:

$$\boxed{d\tau = \Phi^{-1}(x) dt}, \quad \boxed{J^\mu = \Phi u^\mu}, \quad \boxed{\partial_\mu J^\mu = \Gamma(x)}, \quad \boxed{\Gamma(x) = \Gamma_{\text{env}}(x) + \xi \Phi(x) + b |\nabla \Phi(x)|}.$$

In homogeneous cosmology:

$$\boxed{a(t) \propto \Phi^{-1}(t)}, \quad \boxed{H(t) = -\dot{\Phi}/\Phi}, \quad \hbar H_0 \sim 10^{-33} \text{ eV}, \quad H_0 \simeq 2.3 \times 10^{-18} \text{ s}^{-1}.$$

Weak-field dictionary (metrological anchor). In the stationary Newtonian regime ($\mathcal{O}(c^{-2})$),

$$\nabla \ln \Phi \simeq \frac{\nabla \psi}{c^2} \Rightarrow \frac{\Delta \Phi}{\Phi} \simeq \frac{\Delta \psi}{c^2} \approx 1.1 \times 10^{-16} \text{ m}^{-1} \times \Delta h,$$

which aligns reading by optical clocks (centimetric relativistic geodesy) with rhythmic grammar. *Caveat*: phenomenological weak-field map; GR geometry (light cones) is unchanged and no $T_{\mu\nu}$ is added.

Dimensionless residual & falsifiability (reminder of Box 1). The non-metric signature is read by

$$\boxed{\left(\frac{\Delta \nu}{\nu}\right)_{\text{res}} = \left(\frac{\Delta \nu}{\nu}\right)_{\text{obs}} - \left(\frac{\Delta \nu}{\nu}\right)_{\text{GR}} = \varepsilon_\Phi},$$

with *anti-gauge loops* (co-local null tests, link permutations, A–B–C–A loops, forward/backward sequences) to lift timestamp and medium degeneracies. *Acceptance criteria*: (i) co-local nulls compatible with noise; (ii) ε_Φ stable under link permutation; (iii) persistence on closed loops; (iv) negative regressions on controls (temperature, optical load, vibrations).

Operational note (scope). Φ is introduced to constrain *inter-system* synchronizability via relational closure. It is not a trajectory-local parameter (proper time) and not an intra-system decoherence rate. In practice, only GR-subtracted, gauge-safe residuals and loop closures are treated as admissible observables.

Minimal dynamics (kinematic, non-energetic). Without positing any new energy source, we model tempo alignment by a relaxation–diffusion along u^μ :

$$u^\mu \nabla_\mu \Phi = -\gamma(\Phi - \Phi_0) + D \Delta_\perp \Phi,$$

where $\gamma > 0$ (slow return), $D \geq 0$ (spatial diffusivity of phases) and $\Delta_\perp = h^{\mu\nu} \nabla_\mu \nabla_\nu$ with $h^{\mu\nu} = g^{\mu\nu} + u^\mu u^\nu$. This law suffices to derive the *first-order* dependences used in the P1–P4 pipeline:

- **P1 — Clocks (vertical):** constrain $|\varepsilon_\Phi|$ at sub- 10^{-18} over $\Delta h \sim \text{cm–m}$; co-local null tests and fiber/GNSS/free-space permutations.
- **P2 — Qubits (cQED/ions):** differential extraction of ξ via $\dot{C} = -(\Gamma_{env} + \xi\Phi + b|\nabla\Phi|)C$ (towers/parabolic flights) with controls T_1/T_φ ; includes the *entangled-pair* case.
- **P3 — Long baselines** (10^2 – 10^4 km): multi-site correlated drifts $S_y(f)$ and veto by independent links.
- **P4 — Cognition (exploratory):** minimal detectable effect $\Delta\text{PLV} \sim 0.03$ – 0.05 under controlled reference jitter (< 1 ms) and pre-registered analyses.

Semantic clarification. “Beat / breathing / cycle” refer to $T(x) = \Phi(x)^{-1}$ and to *compatibility windows* $\tau_{\text{win}} \sim 1/\Delta\Phi$; this is not an absolute periodicity, but a local metric of *tenue*.

Formal pointer (proofs). Demonstrations (linearization, conservation, covariance, dimensions of Φ , weak-field links, estimation of ε_Φ and loop properties) are detailed in the *Formal Appendices* of **Article 2 Chronon Field and the End of Timeless Physics** (A–C).

VI — Conclusion: Learning to Beat True

Time is not an arrow, it is a *tenue*. It does not advance, it restarts: at each beat, something is remade, tuned, shifted, lost. Reading the real as *rhythm*—via the local frequency of coherence $\Phi(x)$ —is not a stylistic effect, but an *operational choice*: measure cadences, verify null tests, seek common correlations across sites and platforms.

This manifesto set the minimal framework: (i) *master laws* of reparametrization ($d\tau = \Phi^{-1}dt$, $J^\mu = \Phi u^\mu$, $\partial_\mu J^\mu = \Gamma$); (ii) a *weak-field anchor* linking $\nabla \ln \Phi$ to known gravitational redshifts; (iii) a *dimensionless residual* ε_Φ readable by clock comparisons after GR subtraction; (iv) a *P1–P4 pipeline* (clocks, qubits, long baselines, cognition) equipped with thresholds and anti-gauge loops. Falsifiability is not a slogan: it is the method. If the null tests fail, ε_Φ falls. If common drifts disappear under link permutations, the signal is not rhythmic. If controlled regressions do not separate ξ from b , the proposed coupling must be rejected or bounded more tightly.

Learning to “beat true” means articulating metrology and lived experience: the *public hour* (UTC/GNSS/PTP/NTP) coordinates, cadence gives meaning. A politics of rhythm begins by restoring *windows of tenue* compatible with the living; a physics of rhythm begins by recognizing that coherence can be instrumented—and therefore measured.

Formal pointer. Proofs, linearizations and controls (dimensions of Φ , covariance, continuity law, construction of anti-gauge loops, bounds on ξ, b , and estimates of ε_Φ) are detailed in the *Formal Appendices* of **Article 2 Chronon Field and the End of Timeless Physics**.

The real beats, but what is beating? Being itself. That will be the subject of the next article: Ontology of Rhythm.

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